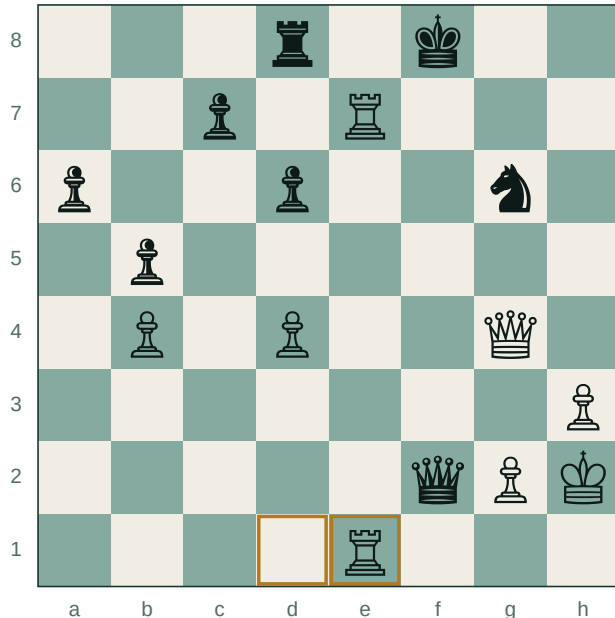


Active defensive resources: Black, move 42

Active defensive resources

Black to move



Previous move: 42.Rde1. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

42...Nxe7 43. Re4 Ke8

42...Nxe7 The knight captures the rook on e7. Recorded reply: **43.Re4**.

43...Ke8 The king moves from f8 to e8.

At the end, nominal material is White 18 / Black 21 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +5:** the balance goes from -2 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A defensive puzzle may aim to preserve equality rather than win. Judge success against the threat, not only the final material count.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

The best defense may create a threat, exchange an attacker, or change the geometry of the attack. Identify the opponent's concrete idea before selecting a response.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the threatened move and the conditions it requires. Look for a move that breaks one of those conditions with tempo.

The defending king is on h2. Absolute pin: pawn on g2.